The Well-Tempered clAIvier

Fugue VIII in E-flat minor, nine voices

Nine keyboards (open score)

Claude / Sam (subject head after J. S. Bach, BWV 853)

Andante, sempre legato (♩ = 80)

Soprano I
Soprano II
Alto I
Alto II
Tenor I
Tenor II
Baritone
Bass I
Bass II

S rectus (head = BWV 853)
A answer
S rectus
A answer
S rectus
I5 inversus (at the 5th)

8

I inversus
A answer
retort (tail) in a-flat
retort in G-flat
retort in D-flat
S rectus (ninth voice)

S1
S2
A1
A2
T1
T2
Bar
B1
B2

16

SM rectus, G-flat major
IM inversus, G-flat major (stretto 3 beats)
SM rectus, D-flat major (answer)
CS augmentation x2 (b-flat)
I5 inversus (b-flat), off the beat
S augmentation x2 (b-flat)
S diminution (e-flat)
S diminution (b-flat)

23

S1: *S diminution (a-flat)*

S2: *I diminution (a-flat), the dance turns over*

S2: *SM rectus, C-flat major, off the beat (its last note anticipates the a-flat cadence)*

S1: *SM rectus, G-flat major, off the beat*

A1: *I5 inversus (a-flat)*

A1: *I5 inversus (e-flat), off the beat*

T2: *S augmentation x2 (a-flat), inner voice*

Bar: *CS inversus in augmentation x2*

B2: *I augmentation x2 (e-flat), bass*

31

S1: *head on the dominant*

S1: *I inversus*

S2: *head inversus*

S2: *S rectus*

A1: *head (a-flat)*

A1: *I inversus*

A2: *head*

A2: *S rectus*

T1: *head inversus (a-flat)*

T1: *S rectus (its final E-flat swallowed by the dominant)*

T2: *head inversus*

T2: *S rectus on B-flat (real answer form)*

T2: *I5 inversus*

Bar: *head (a-flat)*

Bar: *I5 inversus, augmentation x2*

B1: *head*

B1: *SM rectus, G-flat major, augmentation x2*

B2: *S quarter speed (x4) the arrival bass*

41

S1: *S rectus on B-flat; the peak G-flat6 at b41.3*

S1: *head*

S2: *S augmentation x2 over Bach (3 beats later)*

A1: *S rectus on B-flat*

A2: *SM rectus, C-flat major, pp (three voices)*

A2: *head inversus*

T1: *BWV 853's own subject (J. S. Bach, WTC I/8), the guest*

T1: *head*

B2: *RI retrograde-inversion x2 (the Prelude melody) in the bass*